

DESIGN SYSTEM / INSTRUMENT / INTERNAL

# KEYSTROKE

Let us push the buttons for you.

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PALETTE

Instrument, adopted 2026-09-18

TOKENS VERSION

2

LAST CHANGE

2026-09-18 / Kieran

NAMESPACE

Keystroke

# 01 BRAND BOOK

KEYSTROKE takes the manual admin out of Australian businesses of 5–50 staff and rebuilds it so it runs itself. A keystroke is the unit of wasted human effort. We count them, then we delete them. Every piece of this system exists to make that number visible and to make it go down.

Two principals. A crew of software agents that runs overnight. The agents are named as agents, always.

## CONTENT FUNDAMENTALS

Write flat, precise, and faintly amused by waste. Australian English throughout — colour, organisation, recognise, licence as a noun, metres, GST. Numbers instead of adjectives.

Write like this:

Somebody in your office types the same invoice details three times. We counted.

We don't sell transformation. We sell a smaller number than the one you've got.

The crew runs at 4am. Nobody types anything.

Rules that hold everywhere:

- **Lead with the number.** If a sentence has a figure in it, the figure goes first or the sentence gets cut. Set every figure in the `Data` group — `counter-s` inside a card, `figure` inside a paragraph. Numbers never sit in the body face.
- **State the count, not the feeling.** "14,600 keystrokes a year" is the claim. "Huge time savings" is not a claim.
- **No enthusiasm and no reassurance.** No exclamation marks, no "we're excited", no "don't worry". The work is the reassurance.
- **No category vocabulary.** The following never appear in KEYSTROKE copy: AI-powered, seamless, next-generation, solutions that scale, unlock, digital experiences, transformation, journey, empower, leverage, robust, innovative, cutting-edge.
- **Agents are agents.** Write "the crew", "an agent", "a unit". Never "our team member", never a human first name for a machine, never a photograph or avatar standing in for one. Every crew surface carries the line `Not a person`.
- **Sentence case for copy, upper case for structure.** Headlines, eyebrows and display type are upper case. Body copy is sentence case. Nothing is Title Case.
- **No emoji, ever.** Not in copy, not in interfaces, not in email.

Full voice guidance, an approved copy bank and the tagline lock-up rules are in **Voice**.

## VISUAL FOUNDATIONS

### COLOUR

The palette is **Instrument**: graphite, cold steel and two states. A measuring instrument is dark so that the readout is the only lit thing on it, and that is the whole argument. Dark is theme one; light exists for documents and print, not as an equal.

There is no hue anywhere in this system except two facts — the crew is running, and a number is being removed. A screen with colour on it is a screen where something is happening.

| TOKEN          | IS                                                      | IS NEVER                                      |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| base-000       | the page                                                | type, or a panel on itself                    |
| base-100       | one step down: row banding, wells, cards                | a second-level card, a substitute for a rule  |
| base-900       | counter housings, hero band, footer, keycap shell       | a button, a hover state, decoration           |
| rule           | borders that carry meaning; the side of a keycap        | decorative padding rules                      |
| hairline       | drum seams, baseline grids, tally ticks                 | field borders, focus rings, control edges     |
| ink            | primary type, meaningful rules, the figure that remains | anything that must recede                     |
| ink-muted      | labels, units, footnotes, status text                   | figures, headlines                            |
| ink-inverse    | type and rules on base-900                              | anything on base-000 or base-100 in light     |
| readout        | counter digits, keycap face, crew plate                 | body copy, headlines, a background            |
| live           | a mark only: the pulse dot, the active keyline          | text of any size, links, buttons, headings    |
| signal         | the number at the moment it is removed                  | links, errors, buttons, headings, "attention" |
| signal-inverse | the same, on base-900                                   | anything on a light ground                    |
| focus          | a 2px square ink ring                                   | a glow, signal, live                          |

Three rules do most of the work:

- signal is rationed.** One instance per screen, on the delta or the struck baseline. A settled figure is always ink or readout . If a second red appears, the screen has stopped being about a single number going down and needs re-cutting.
- readout and ink-inverse are materials, not modes.** They hold one value in both themes, because a lit surface does not change when the room does.
- live is never text.** It is a 9px square, a 2px keyline, and nothing else. On base-900 it takes the dark theme's value.

hairline is deliberately below 3:1 and may not carry meaning — use rule when a border has to be understood. Every text pair in both themes holds 4.5:1 or better; rule holds 3.3:1 on base-000 and 3.4:1 on base-900 .

## TYPOGRAPHY

Three families, three jobs, no overlap.

| JOB               | LICENSED FACE                  | LICENSABLE FALLBACK     | FAMILY KEY |
|-------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------|------------|
| Display           | Knockout (Hoefler&Co)          | Oswald (SIL OFL)        | display    |
| Body              | Söhne (Klim Type Foundry)      | Archivo (SIL OFL)       | body       |
| Data and numerals | Söhne Mono (Klim Type Foundry) | IBM Plex Mono (SIL OFL) | data       |

Knockout is a matrix of 32 widths and weights — a catalogue of sizes rather than a personality, which is the right register for a firm that machines things. Oswald descends from Alternate Gothic and holds the same condensed, unsentimental line at no licence cost.

Söhne and Söhne Mono share one skeleton, so a word in body and a figure in data sit on a line without a step. Archivo and IBM Plex Mono do the same job under an open

licence; Plex Mono was drawn for a machine company and its digits are square enough to read as drums.

Rules:

- Every figure is tabular. Set `font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums` on anything in the `data` group. A counter whose columns shift as it counts is broken.
- Display styles are upper case only. If a display style renders in mixed case, the wrong style was used.
- `eyebrow` appears once per block, above the headline — `ink-muted` on `base-000`, `readout` on `base-900`.
- Body copy never exceeds 66 characters a line.
- No italics anywhere in the system. Emphasis is a figure or a rule, not a slant.

## LAYOUT, SPACING AND RADII

A 4px base with one odd step. `space-19` is 76px — the 19.05mm keycap pitch rounded. Anything that carries keys or digit cells is built on it: counter cells are `space-19` wide, the counter housing band is `space-19` tall, the letterhead's left margin is `space-19`.

Radii stop at 6px. `radius-cap` is the outer shell of a keycap, `radius-key` is its inner face and a digit cell, and `radius-0` is everything else — tables, tiles, fields, stationery. There are no pills and there are no circles in this system.

## BORDERS, SHADOWS AND STATES

Borders do the work shadows do elsewhere. `shadow-rest` is one hard 2px offset in `rule` with no blur, and it is only ever applied to something key-shaped. `shadow-press` is the same offset at 1px with the surface moved 1px down. Everything else takes `shadow-none`: cards, tiles, counters and panels do not float.

Focus is a 2px square ring in `focus`, offset 2px. No glow, no colour change, no `signal`, no `live`.

## IMAGERY

Close-crop macro, shot flat, no people, fully desaturated. A worn key. A mouse with the finish gone off it. A spreadsheet at 400% zoom until the grid stops being a grid. Full shot brief in **Imagery and motion**.

Until the shoot exists, surfaces use the drawn keycap stand-in shown in the hero. It is a placeholder and is labelled as one — it is not a mark and must not be treated as one.

## MOTION

Motion is decrement. Numbers roll down, tallies clear, cells empty. Nothing fades in, nothing eases up, nothing bounces. A digit drum rolls in 180ms with a linear timing function because a mechanism does not ease. A clearance holds its signal-red state for 400ms and then it is gone. Full rules in **Imagery and motion**.

# ICONOGRAPHY

There is no icon set and there will not be one. The system has three marks — one per logotype direction — and beyond that it draws mechanisms: tally strokes, digit cells, keycaps, rules. Where a UI genuinely needs a glyph, set it in the `data` family as a character (`/`, `-`, `+`, `×`) rather than importing a picture of one.

The marks live in the **Marks** asset group as flat SVG with their ink baked in, because an SVG served through `<img>` cannot inherit colour. Pick the `-dark` file on `base-000` in the dark theme and on `base-900`; pick the `-light` file on `base-000` and `base-100` in the light theme. `keycap-mark.svg` carries its own two-tone and works on either. Inline SVG, by contrast, should bind every fill to a token and will theme itself.

# LOGOTYPES

Three directions are built, each wordmark-led with a reduced mark that holds at 32px: **Tally**, **Drum** and **Keycap**. They are alternatives, not a family — one gets chosen and the other two get deleted. What each one costs, and which ones the Instrument palette helps, is in **Logotypes**.

# BUILDING WITH THIS SYSTEM

A paste-ready `:root` block, the counter markup, the theme switch and the font loading are in **Build notes**. Read that before writing any HTML against this system; it exists so that two people building different pages produce the same page.

# THE NUMBER

The counter is the brand. A brand built on a countable thing is only as good as the count, so the method is published and the figure is never rounded up. How a keystroke is defined, measured and audited is in **Counting method** — read it before putting a number on anything.

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# COLOUR TOKENS

Twelve tokens, two themes. Dark is theme one; light exists for documents and print. `readout`, `ink-inverse` and `signal-inverse` are materials and hold one value in both themes.

| TOKEN                             | DARK                                                                                           | LIGHT                                                                                          | USAGE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>base-000</b>                   | <br>#0b0d10   | <br>#ffffff   | The page. Every surface starts here. NOT type, NOT a panel sitting on itself, and never warmed toward beige to soften it.                                                                                                                            |
| <b>base-100</b>                   | <br>#14181c   | <br>#f4f6f8   | One step down: table row banding, input wells, the inset behind a figure, a card on the page. NOT a second-level card stacked on another card, and NOT a substitute for a rule.                                                                      |
| <b>base-900</b>                   | <br>#07090b   | <br>#0b0d10   | Counter housings, the hero band, the footer, the keycap shell. The only always-dark ground in the system. NOT a button fill, NOT a hover state, NOT decoration.                                                                                      |
| <b>rule</b>                       | <br>#5c666f   | <br>#8a939d   | Borders that carry meaning: counter cell dividers, table structure, the edge of a field, the side of a keycap. 3.3:1 on base-000 and 3.4:1 on base-900. NOT decorative padding rules.                                                                |
| <b>hairline</b>                   | <br>#1e252b   | <br>#e4e9ed   | Decorative separation only: the drum seam, baseline grids, tally ticks, the foot of a card. Below 3:1 by design, so NOT a field border, NOT a focus ring, NOT a control edge.                                                                        |
| <b>ink</b>                        | <br>#e6eae    | <br>#0b0d10   | All primary type on base-000 and base-100, meaningful rules, and the figure that remains after a clearance. NOT anything that must recede.                                                                                                           |
| <b>ink-muted</b>                  | <br>#8d97a2 | <br>#5b6672 | Labels, units, footnotes, field names, status text. NOT figures, NOT headlines, and never used to make a sentence sound tentative.                                                                                                                   |
| <b>ink-inverse</b><br>MATERIAL    | <br>#e6eae  | <br>#e6eae  | Type and rules on base-900. A material, so it holds one value across both themes. NOT anything on base-000 or base-100 in the light theme.                                                                                                           |
| <b>readout</b><br>MATERIAL        | <br>#d6dee6 | <br>#d6dee6 | The lit surface of the instrument: counter digits, the keycap face, the crew plate legend. One value across both themes, because a lit surface does not change when the room does. NOT body copy, NOT headlines, NOT a page or card background.      |
| <b>live</b>                       | <br>#4ea8ff | <br>#0b5fd0 | One state, and only ever as a mark: the pulse dot when the crew is running, the active nav keyline, the head-rule of a live tile. On base-900 it takes the dark value. NOT text at any size, NOT links, NOT buttons, NOT headings, NOT chart series. |
| <b>signal</b>                     | <br>#ff5247 | <br>#cc1f14 | The number at the moment it is removed, and nothing else: the delta, the minus, the struck baseline. NOT links, NOT errors, NOT buttons, NOT headings, NOT 'attention'. If it appears twice on a screen the screen is wrong.                         |
| <b>signal-inverse</b><br>MATERIAL | <br>#ff5247 | <br>#ff5247 | The same figure when it sits on base-900. NOT anything on base-000 or base-100 in the light theme.                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>focus</b><br>MATERIAL          | <br>#e6eae  | <br>#0b0d10 | The focus ring: 2px, square, solid, offset 2px. NOT a glow, NOT signal red, NOT live blue.                                                                                                                                                           |

03

TYPOGRAPHY

Three families, three jobs, no overlap. Licensed faces are Knockout, Söhne and Söhne Mono; the samples below render on the open fallbacks.

DISPLAY — KNOCKOUT, OSWALD, 'ARIAL NARROW', SANS-SERIF

| STYLE      | SPEC                         | SAMPLE                           | USAGE                                                         |
|------------|------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| display-xl | 88px / 80px · 600 · -0.01em  | LET US<br>PUSH<br>THE<br>BUTTONS | Hero headline. One per page.<br>Upper case only.              |
| display-l  | 56px / 52px · 600 · -0.005em | WE COUNTED                       | Section openers and case-study<br>headlines. Upper case only. |
| display-m  | 34px / 34px · 500            | THE CREW RUNS AT 4AM             | Card headings, letterhead<br>masthead. Upper case only.       |
| display-s  | 22px / 24px · 500 · 0.01em   | SCOPE                            | Sub-headings inside a card.<br>Upper case only.               |

TEXT — SOHNE, ARCHIVO, HELVETICA, ARIAL, SANS-SERIF

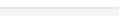
| STYLE   | SPEC                       | SAMPLE                                                                 | USAGE                                                                                                       |
|---------|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| lede    | 19px / 28px · 400          | Somebody in your office types the<br>same invoice details three times. | The one paragraph under a hero.<br>Sentence case. Never more than<br>three sentences.                       |
| body    | 16px / 25px · 400          | We rebuilt the intake so the form writes the<br>job.                   | Running copy on base-000 and base-<br>100, in ink.                                                          |
| body-s  | 14px / 21px · 400          | Six weeks. Two systems. One import.                                    | Card copy, captions, notes, in ink or<br>ink-muted.                                                         |
| eyebrow | 12px / 16px · 600 · 0.14em | CASE 014                                                               | Upper-case eyebrows above a<br>headline, in ink-muted on base-000 or<br>readout on base-900. One per block. |

| STYLE      | SPEC                         | SAMPLE              | USAGE                                                                                                        |
|------------|------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| counter-xl | 116px / 104px · 500 · 0.01em | 812,000             | The homepage tally. One instance per page, always tabular.                                                   |
| counter-m  | 54px / 50px · 500            | 41,900              | Section and tile figures. Always tabular.                                                                    |
| counter-s  | 24px / 24px · 500            | 1,204,880           | Inline figures inside a card, a table row or a letterhead footer. Always tabular.                            |
| figure     | 15px / 22px · 400            | 02:00-05:40 AEST    | Any number, time, code or reference inside running copy. Numbers never sit in the body face.                 |
| plate      | 11px / 14px · 500 · 0.16em   | UNIT 07 / RECONCILE | Stamped identification lines: crew designations, document references, counter labels, the letterhead footer. |

# SPACING, RADIUS AND SHADOW

## SPACING

A 4px base, with one odd step: space-19 is the 19.05mm keycap pitch rounded to 76px.  
Anything carrying keys or digit cells uses it.

| TOKEN    | VALUE | SCALE                                                                             | USAGE                                                                                                                                             |
|----------|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| space-1  | 4px   |  | Gap between a figure and its unit; the keycap seam.                                                                                               |
| space-2  | 8px   |  | Gap between digit cells where a counter is gapped.                                                                                                |
| space-3  | 12px  |  | Label to figure.                                                                                                                                  |
| space-4  | 16px  |  | Card padding at small sizes; paragraph spacing.                                                                                                   |
| space-6  | 24px  |  | Card padding at default size; gap between stacked blocks.                                                                                         |
| space-8  | 32px  |  | Gutter between tiles; letterhead margin at top.                                                                                                   |
| space-12 | 48px  |  | Section padding; distance from a headline to its rule.                                                                                            |
| space-19 | 76px  |  | Keycap pitch. Width of an XL digit cell, height of a counter housing band, left margin of a letterhead and of the homepage. Nothing else uses it. |
| space-24 | 96px  |  | Vertical rhythm between major page sections.                                                                                                      |

## RADIUS

Nothing in the system is rounder than 6px. There are no pills and no circles.

| TOKEN      | VALUE | USAGE                                                            |
|------------|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| radius-0   | 0     | Rules, tables, fields, tiles, counters, stationery. The default. |
| radius-key | 3px   | The inner face of a keycap, and a gapped digit cell.             |
| radius-cap | 6px   | The outer shell of a keycap. The largest radius permitted.       |

## SHADOW

One hard offset, no blur, no spread, no opacity. A surface is either resting or pressed,  
and only key-shaped things cast anything at all.

| TOKEN        | VALUE                                        | USAGE                                                                           |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| shadow-rest  | Dark 0 2px 0 #5c666f · Light 0 2px 0 #8a939d | A keycap or key-shaped control at rest. The offset is the key's side, in rule.  |
| shadow-press | Dark 0 1px 0 #5c666f · Light 0 1px 0 #8a939d | The same control held down, with the surface moved 1px toward it.               |
| shadow-none  | none                                         | Everything else. Cards, tiles, counters, plates and panels do not cast shadows. |

Flat, precise, faintly amused by waste. The tone of someone reading a meter, who has read a lot of meters, and who has noticed something about yours.

## THE THREE TESTS

A line ships if it passes all three.

1. **Is there a number in it?** If not, is there a reason there isn't one?
2. **Would a competitor write this?** If the sentence would sit comfortably on any other firm's site, it is not a KEYSTROKE sentence.
3. **Does it promise a feeling?** Delete it. We promise a smaller number.

## APPROVED COPY BANK

Homepage and hero:

Let us push the buttons for you.

812,000 keystrokes cleared this year.

We don't sell transformation. We sell a smaller number than the one you've got.

Explaining the work:

Somebody in your office types the same invoice details three times. We counted.

Your quote lives in four places. It should live in one and tell the other three.

We rebuilt the intake so the form writes the job. Nobody retypes the address.

The crew:

The crew runs at 4am. Nobody types anything.

Seven agents. None of them are people. None of them take leave.

An agent does not get bored on the four hundredth invoice, which is the entire point.

Pricing and objections:

We quote the build. We don't quote the transformation, because there isn't one.

If the number doesn't move, you don't pay for the month it didn't move in.

Sign-off:

We counted. Here's the number.

## THE TAGLINE

**Let us push the buttons for you.**

- Sentence case with the full stop. Never upper case, never without the stop.
- Set in `lede`, sentence case, when it sits under a wordmark. When it is the page's own headline it is set in `display-xl` or `display-l` — upper case, full stop kept. Upper case is the only change permitted to it.
- Minimum clear space around it is `space-6` on all sides.
- It is never set in `signal`, never set on `readout` or `live`, and never abbreviated to "Push the buttons".

- It may sit directly under a logotype lockup only in the Tally and Keycap directions. The Drum lockup carries its own descender rule and is used alone.

## CASING AND PUNCTUATION

- Upper case: display styles, `eyebrow`, `plate`. Nothing else.
- Sentence case: all body copy, the tagline, buttons, form labels.
- Never Title Case.
- Full stops on all sentences including single-sentence blocks and the tagline.
- No exclamation marks. No em-dash pile-ups — one per paragraph at most.
- Ampersand only inside a registered business name.
- No emoji, in any surface, ever.

## NUMBERS

- Comma thousands separators: 812,000. Not 812K, not 812k, not 0.8M.
- Never round up. Round down to the nearest hundred if a figure needs shortening, and say so.
- A figure gets its unit in `ink-muted` beside it, never inside it: **41,900** keystrokes.
- Time is 24-hour with the zone: 02:00–05:40 AEST.
- Currency is written \$4,200 with no cents unless the cents matter.
- A range takes an en dash with no spaces: 5–50 staff.

## WORDS THAT ARE BANNED

AI-powered · seamless · next-generation · solutions that scale · unlock · digital experiences · transformation · journey · empower · leverage · robust · innovative · cutting-edge · game-changing · best-in-class · synergy · streamline · supercharge · revolutionise · reimagine.

"Automation" is permitted once per page and only where a plainer word would be less accurate. "Software" is preferred to "solution" in every case.

## DESCRIBING THE CREW

The crew is a set of software agents that runs overnight. Every description of it is literal.

Permitted: the crew, an agent, a unit, it, runs, scheduled, overnight, 4am, does not take leave, is not a person.

Not permitted: team member, colleague, our people, meet the team, human first names, photographs, avatars, "works alongside your staff", "like having an extra pair of hands", any pronoun other than it.

Every crew surface carries the status line **Not a person.** in `plate`. It is not a disclaimer at the bottom of a page — it sits in the card, at the same weight as the other fields.

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## 06 LOGOTYPES

Three directions. Each is wordmark-led, each has a lockup and each reduces to a mark that survives at 32px. They are alternatives, not a family — pick one, delete two.

All three set KEYSTROKE in `display` at weight 600, upper case, with the counter aesthetic carried by a different mechanism in each. None uses an abstract icon. None is lowercase. None has a full stop after it.

### 01 — TALLY

**The type treatment.** KEYSTROKE set tight in condensed caps, sitting on a rule that runs the full width of the word and carries nine ticks — one under each letter — plus a tenth stroke struck diagonally across the last five. The word is the tally.

**The lockup.** Wordmark, rule, then the tagline in `Lede` at `space-4` below, left-aligned to the same edge. Minimum width 180px; below that the rule's ticks merge and the lockup fails.

**The reduced mark.** A tally of five — four uprights and the diagonal — at 32px. No letterform.

**Why it's defensible in one sentence.** A stroke is both a keystroke and a tally stroke, so the mark is the unit of measure and the unit of sale at the same time.

**What it costs.** The mark carries no letter, so it has to earn recognition from scratch. It is also the most borrowable of the three — tallies belong to everyone.

### 02 — DRUM

**The type treatment.** Each letter sits in its own fixed-width cell, hairline-divided, at `space-19` pitch reduced to the cap height — an odometer set to spell a word. The final E sits 18% low and is clipped by its cell, caught mid-roll.

**The lockup.** Wordmark alone, with the descender rule under the cell row. It carries no tagline: the mechanism is already saying the sentence. Minimum width 240px — it is the widest and least flexible of the three.

**The reduced mark.** One cell holding a K, offset 2px above centre with the drum seam crossing its lower third.

**Why it's defensible in one sentence.** The logo is a mechanism caught mid-count, so the brand's only promise is stated before a word of copy is read.

**What it costs.** Nine cells is a wide, rigid lockup that will not go in an app icon, a favicon row or a narrow header without dropping to the mark. Budget for the mark being used more often than the wordmark.

### 03 — KEYCAP

**The type treatment.** KEYSTROKE in condensed caps, plain, with the initial K set as a legend on a keycap — `readout` face, `rule` side, `base-900` shell, 2px hard offset, the K's lower leg worn through where a thumb has been.

**The lockup.** Keycap K, then the remaining letters set at cap height on the key's baseline, then the tagline beneath at `space-4`. Works from 120px up, which is the smallest of the three.

**The reduced mark.** The keycap alone: `radius-cap` shell with a `rule` edge, `radius-key` face in `readout`, `base-900` K. Two-tone, so it holds on every ground in the palette

from one file.

**Why it's defensible in one sentence.** The client already owns this object and has already worn it out, which makes the mark a piece of their evidence rather than a piece of our decoration.

**What it costs.** Under Instrument the key face is cold steel rather than aged ivory, which takes most of the warmth out of the worn-object argument the direction rests on — this is the direction the palette helps least. It also ties the identity to a physical keyboard at a moment when a lot of the waste has moved to a phone.

## CHOOSING

- **Most severe, least explanation needed:** Drum. The palette suits it best — an odometer in cold steel is exactly what Instrument is describing.
- **Most flexible across small surfaces:** Keycap. But see its cost above.
- **Most ownable as a symbol if it survives five years of use:** Tally.

With the Instrument palette adopted, **Drum** and **Tally** are the two live candidates.

## RULES THAT APPLY TO WHICHEVER WINS

- Minimum clear space is the cap height of the K on all four sides.
  - The wordmark is `ink` on `base-000` and `base-100`, and `ink-inverse` on `base-900`. The Keycap direction keeps `readout` on the key face in both themes.
  - Never set the wordmark in `signal` or `live`. Red belongs to the number being removed, blue to the crew running, and neither belongs in a logotype.
  - Never outline, never emboss, never add a gradient, never rotate, never letterspace beyond the spec.
  - Never place the wordmark over photography. It sits on a flat ground.
  - Never place it on a colour outside the palette, and never on `readout` or `live` — the contrast fails.
  - Do not build a lowercase variant, and do not add a full stop.
-

# IMAGERY AND MOTION

## PHOTOGRAPHY

One subject: the evidence of repetition. Shoot it the way a parts catalogue shoots a component.

### What is in frame

- A worn key, cropped so the keycap fills 80% of the frame and the legend is half gone.
- The shine on a spacebar where a thumb has sat for six years.
- A mouse with the finish rubbed off the left button and nowhere else.
- A spreadsheet at 400% zoom, held until the grid stops reading as a grid.
- A stack of the same printed form, edge on, forty deep.
- A numeric keypad with the 4, 5 and 6 polished and the rest matte.

### How it is shot

- Flat, even, single-source light. No rim light, no coloured gels, no bokeh.
- Square-on or exactly 90° overhead. No three-quarter hero angles.
- Depth of field deep enough that the whole subject is sharp. The macro is for scale, not for blur.
- Ground is `base-000` or `base-900`. Nothing else.
- Desaturate fully. Under Instrument there is no warm tone left in the palette for plastic yellowing to land on, so any residual warmth in a frame is a grading error, not a feature. The target is a neutral grey scale whose highlights sit near `readout`.

### What is never shot

People, hands mid-gesture, offices, boardrooms, handshakes, screens displaying a dashboard, laptops on desks with a coffee, rooftops, city timelapses, anything shot through glass, anyone smiling at a monitor. No stock. No illustration of a small person beside a large device. No isometric anything.

**Placeholder status.** No shoot exists yet. Surfaces currently use the drawn keycap in the hero, built entirely from tokens so it themes with the page. It is a stand-in, labelled as one, and it is not a mark — it must not be lifted into a logo, a favicon or a social avatar.

## MOTION

Motion is decrement. Something is being removed and you are watching it go.

| EVENT          | BEHAVIOUR                                                                                                      | DURATION            | TIMING                |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|
| Digit roll     | The drum rolls one digit upward, clipped by its cell                                                           | 180ms               | <code>linear</code>   |
| Clearance      | The removed figure holds in <code>signal</code> with a strike, then is gone — it does not fade                 | 400ms hold, 0ms out | <code>steps(1)</code> |
| Live pulse     | The <code>live</code> square holds solid while the crew is running and is absent otherwise — it does not blink | —                   | —                     |
| Tally clear    | Strokes disappear left to right, one per 60ms                                                                  | 60ms per stroke     | <code>linear</code>   |
| Counter settle | The final digit lands and stops. No overshoot                                                                  | —                   | —                     |
| Page section   | Appears. No entrance animation                                                                                 | 0ms                 | —                     |

## Rules:

- `linear` or `steps()` only. No ease-in-out, no spring, no cubic-bezier with a hump. A mechanism does not ease.
  - Nothing fades in. Fading is how a thing arrives; this brand is about things leaving.
  - Nothing scales up. Nothing bounces. Nothing parallaxes.
  - No loading spinners. A process that takes time shows a count.
  - Total motion on any page is one counter and nothing else. If two things are moving, one of them is decoration. The `live` mark does not count as motion because it does not move — a pulsing dot is a decoration pretending to be a state.
  - Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`: the counter shows its settled figure and does not roll. The number is the point, not the roll.
-

## 08 COUNTING METHOD

The brand is a number. A number is only worth as much as its method, so the method is published, the definition is narrow, and the figure is never rounded up.

### WHAT COUNTS AS A KEYSTROKE

One keystroke is **one deliberate input a person makes that the rebuilt system no longer requires**. Counted inputs:

- A character typed into a field.
- A click or tap that selects, confirms, submits or navigates.
- A copy and a paste, counted as two.
- A file attachment, counted as one.

Not counted: reading, deciding, a person choosing to check something, or any input the new system still requires. Time saved is not converted into keystrokes, and keystrokes are not converted into dollars anywhere in KEYSTROKE's own copy.

### HOW A BASELINE IS ESTABLISHED

Before a build, the task is recorded once, start to finish, with the client watching. Inputs are counted from the recording, not estimated. The count is multiplied by the client's own stated frequency — invoices a week, jobs a month — taken from their system's records, not from what anyone remembers.

The baseline is agreed in writing with the client before any figure is published. If the client disputes the frequency, their figure is used.

### HOW THE CLEARED FIGURE ACCRUES

A task's keystroke count moves from baseline to cleared **only after the rebuilt process has run in production for four consecutive weeks without a manual fallback**. A task that is half automated contributes nothing. There is no partial credit.

The running total accrues at the rate the process actually runs. If a client's invoicing runs 60 times a week and each run cleared 32 inputs, the counter advances 1,920 a week — not in a lump on the day it went live.

### STATING THE FIGURE

- The homepage counter states the current calendar year: **812,000 keystrokes cleared this year**. It resets on 1 January and the previous year's total is archived on the counting page, not deleted.
- Client figures are stated per year and rounded **down** to the nearest hundred.
- Any published figure carries its date and its scope. "14,600 a year, across quoting and invoicing, from March 2026."
- A figure that cannot be traced to a recorded baseline does not get published. There is no house average and no industry benchmark.

### AUDIT

The counter reads from a ledger with one row per cleared task per client: baseline count, agreed frequency, go-live date, four-week confirmation date, and the accrual to date. Any client may ask for their own rows and gets them the same week.

If a client stops using a rebuilt process, its accrual stops and the total stops rising. It is not clawed back — the keystrokes were cleared while it ran — but the ledger records

the stop date.

# WHY THIS IS IN THE DESIGN SYSTEM

Every surface in this system puts a figure in the largest type on the page. A designer reaching for `counter-xl` is reaching for a claim. This page is the constraint on that reach: if the number in front of you has not come from the ledger, set the page without it.

---

09

# PALETTE DECISION

**Adopted: Instrument.** 18 September 2026. The tokens in this system are the Instrument set — there is no longer a bone-and-legend variant anywhere, and any surface still using warm neutrals is out of date.

## WHAT WAS CHOSEN

Graphite, cold steel and two states. A measuring instrument is dark so that the readout is the only lit thing on it. Dark is theme one; light is for documents and print.

No hue exists in the system except two facts: `live` means the crew is running right now, `signal` means a number is being removed. Everything else is neutral.

## WHAT WAS REJECTED, AND WHY IT MATTERS LATER

Six other palettes were built and tested against the same applied surfaces. They are gone from this system, but the reasoning is worth keeping, because it is also the reasoning that should kill any future proposal to add a colour.

|             | THE IDEA                                                   | WHY NOT                                                     |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Phosphor    | Near-black with one lit amber — the key legend switched on | The warmth was the thing that wasn't landing; amber kept it |
| Blueprint   | Cool paper and a structural blue, light-first              | Easiest to approve and easiest to mistake for a consultancy |
| Oxide       | Black with two reds, one framing and one removing          | Two reds put the one-red rule at risk in print              |
| Emergency   | Red LED readout; removal shown as white                    | Only works on black; the rule has to be stated twice        |
| Ultraviolet | Violet for what remains, red for what goes                 | Violet is the current default colour of software branding   |
| Plum        | A purple-cast ground rather than black plus violet         | A tinted ground is unforgiving in print and on a projector  |

## THE STANDING RULE THIS CREATES

Instrument was chosen because it spends almost no hue. That is the position, not an accident of taste. So:

- **A new colour is not added to this system without removing one.** Twelve tokens is the budget.
- `live` and `signal` are the only chromatic values, and each means exactly one thing. A proposal to use either for emphasis, for a chart series, for a button or for a second status is a proposal to break the system.
- **Warmth is out.** No beige, no ivory, no amber, no cream — including in photography grading, in a chart, or in a partner's co-branded material.

## KNOWN CONSEQUENCE

The Keycap logotype direction rests on a worn, aged object. Under Instrument the key face is cold steel, which takes most of the warmth out of that argument. **Drum** and **Tally** are the two directions the palette actually helps; if Keycap is chosen anyway, that tension is a deliberate choice and should be written down as one.

---

## 10 BUILD NOTES

Everything needed to build an HTML page against this system without guessing. Read this before writing markup; it exists so two people building different pages produce the same page.

# TOKENS AS CSS

Paste this block. Dark is the default; the light theme is opt-in with `data-theme="light"` on `<html>`.

```
:root {
  --base-000:#0b0d10; --base-100:#14181c; --base-900:#07090b;
  --rule:#5c666f;    --hairline:#1e252b;
  --ink:#e6eae;      --ink-muted:#8d97a2; --ink-inverse:#e6eae;
  --readout:#d6dee6;  --live:#4ea8ff;
  --signal:#ff5247;   --signal-inverse:#ff5247;
  --focus:var(--ink);

  --shadow-rest:0 2px 0 #5c666f;
  --shadow-press:0 1px 0 #5c666f;

  --space-1:4px;  --space-2:8px;  --space-3:12px;  --space-4:16px;
  --space-6:24px; --space-8:32px;  --space-12:48px;
  --space-19:76px; --space-24:96px;

  --radius-0:0; --radius-key:3px; --radius-cap:6px;

  --font-display:Knockout, Oswald, "Arial Narrow", sans-serif;
  --font-body:Sohne, Archivo, Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif;
  --font-data:"Sohne Mono", "IBM Plex Mono", ui-monospace, monospace;
}

[data-theme="light"] {
  --base-000:#ffffff; --base-100:#f4f6f8; --base-900:#0b0d10;
  --rule:#8a939d;    --hairline:#e4e9ed;
  --ink:#0b0d10;     --ink-muted:#5b6672;
  --live:#0b5fd0;    --signal:#ccl1f14;
  --shadow-rest:0 2px 0 #8a939d;
  --shadow-press:0 1px 0 #8a939d;
}

html { background:var(--base-000); color:var(--ink); }
body { margin:0; font-family:var(--font-body); -webkit-font-smoothing:antialiased; }
:focus-visible { outline:2px solid var(--focus); outline-offset:2px; }
```

`--ink-inverse`, `--readout` and `--signal-inverse` do not appear in the light block.

They are materials and hold one value in both themes.

# FONTS

Licensed: Knockout (Hoefler&Co), Söhne and Söhne Mono (Klim). Until those licences are in place, the open fallbacks render correctly and are what every canvas in this system uses:

```
<link rel="preconnect" href="https://fonts.gstatic.com" crossorigin>
<link rel="stylesheet" href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?
family=Oswald:wght@400;500;600;700&family=Archivo:wght@400;500;600;700&family=IBM+Plex+Mono:wght@400;500;600&display=swap">
```

Every element in the `data` family needs `font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums`. Set it once:

```
.num, .ctr, [class*="counter"] { font-variant-numeric:tabular-nums; font-feature-settings:"tnum" 1; }
```

# THE COUNTER

The one component every page has. Markup:

```
<div class="ctr" data-size="m">
  <span class="d">8</span><span class="d">1</span><span class="d">2</span>
  <span class="c">,</span>
  <span class="d">0</span><span class="d">0</span><span class="d">0</span>
</div>
<p class="plate">Keystrokes cleared this year</p>
```

```
.ctr{display:inline-flex;background:var(--base-900);border:1px solid var(--rule)}
.ctr .d,.ctr .c{position:relative;overflow:hidden;display:flex;align-items:center;
  justify-content:center;color:var(--readout);font-family:var(--font-data);font-weight:500;
  font-variant-numeric:tabular-nums;border-right:1px solid var(--rule);flex:none}
.ctr .c{color:var(--rule)}
.ctr > :last-child{border-right:0}
.ctr[data-size="xl"] .d{width:76px;height:104px;font-size:76px;line-height:1}
.ctr[data-size="xl"] .c{width:32px;height:104px;font-size:76px;line-height:1}
.ctr[data-size="m"] .d{width:40px;height:58px;font-size:42px;line-height:1}
.ctr[data-size="m"] .c{width:18px;height:58px;font-size:42px;line-height:1}
.ctr[data-size="s"] .d{width:21px;height:30px;font-size:21px;line-height:1}
.ctr[data-size="s"] .c{width:10px;height:30px;font-size:21px;line-height:1}
.ctr .seam{position:absolute;left:0;right:0;top:62%;height:1px;background:var(--hairline)}
```

A rolling digit holds two spans in one cell, the outgoing translating out and the incoming translating in over 180ms, `linear`. Under `prefers-reduced-motion: reduce`, render the settled figure and do not roll.

XL appears once per site, on the homepage. M is for section and tile figures. S is for a figure inside a card, a table row or a letterhead footer. The label always sits outside the housing, in `plate`.

## RULES A BUILD MUST NOT BREAK

- **One `signal` per screen**, on the delta or the struck baseline only. A settled figure is `ink` or `readout`.
- **`live` is never text**. A 9px square or a 2px keyline, and only while the crew is actually running.
- **No shadow except on key-shaped things**. Cards, tiles, counters and plates take `shadow-none`.
- **No radius above 6px**, no pills, no circles.
- **Every figure in the `data` family**. Numbers never sit in the body face, including mid-sentence.
- **Body copy never exceeds 66 characters a line**. Display styles are upper case only.
- **No icon library**. Where a glyph is needed, set a character in the `data` family.
- **Inline SVG binds every fill to a token** so it themes itself. Only files in the **Marks** group have baked ink.

## ACCESSIBILITY FLOORS THIS SYSTEM ALREADY MEETS

Every text pair holds 4.5:1 or better in both themes. `rule` holds 3.3:1 on `base-000` and 3.4:1 on `base-900`; `live` holds 7.8:1 as a mark. `hairline` is deliberately below 3:1 and is barred from anything that carries meaning. A new colour pair added to a page is the build's responsibility to check against the same floors.

# WHAT IS NOT YET SETTLED

- **The logotype direction.** Three are specified; one has to win. Drum and Tally are the two the palette helps.
  - **Photography.** No shoot exists; the hero uses a drawn, token-built stand-in that is labelled as one.
  - **Type licences.** Knockout and Söhne are specified, not bought. Everything currently renders on the open fallbacks.
  - **The ledger behind the counter.** No figure goes on a page until it comes from it — see **Counting method**.
-

## 11 MARKS

The reduced marks for the three logotype directions, at 32×32. One per direction, plus dark- and light-ground variants where the mark is single-ink.

An SVG served through `<img>` cannot inherit colour, so each file has its ink baked in. Inline SVG is different — bind every fill to a token there and it will theme itself. These files exist for favicons, email signatures, app icons and anything else that has to be a file.

| FILE                         | DIRECTION | INK                                                                                                                                                      | USE ON                                                                                             |
|------------------------------|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>tally-light.svg</code> | 01 Tally  | <code>ink</code> (light theme) <code>#0b0d10</code>                                                                                                      | <code>base-000</code> , <code>base-100</code> in the light theme                                   |
| <code>tally-dark.svg</code>  | 01 Tally  | <code>ink</code> (dark theme) <code>#e6eae6</code>                                                                                                       | <code>base-000</code> , <code>base-100</code> in the dark theme, and <code>base-900</code> in both |
| <code>drum-light.svg</code>  | 02 Drum   | cell <code>#0b0d10</code> , K knocked to <code>#ffffff</code>                                                                                            | <code>base-000</code> , <code>base-100</code> in the light theme                                   |
| <code>drum-dark.svg</code>   | 02 Drum   | cell <code>#e6eae6</code> , K knocked to <code>#0b0d10</code>                                                                                            | the dark theme, and <code>base-900</code> in both                                                  |
| <code>keycap-mark.svg</code> | 03 Keycap | shell <code>base-900</code> <code>#0b0d10</code> with a <code>rule</code> edge, face <code>readout</code> <code>#d6dee6</code> , K <code>base-900</code> | any ground in the palette, either theme                                                            |

Rules:

- Minimum size is 32px. These are drawn for 32 and hold to about 24 before the tally ticks and the drum seam close up. Below 24, use the wordmark or nothing.
- Clear space is 4px at 32px — one eighth of the mark — on all four sides.
- Never recolour a file. If a ground needs a variant that is not here, one gets drawn; the fills are not swapped in CSS because `<img>` will not carry it.
- Never place a mark in `signal` or `live`.
- These are marks, not illustrations. The drawn keycap in the hero is a photography stand-in and is not one of these files.

The full lockups are type-set in Knockout (or Oswald as the licensable fallback) and are specified in **Logotypes** rather than shipped as files. They ship as outlined SVG once a direction is chosen and the display licence is settled.

---

# COMPONENTS

Eight components. Each entry is the guideline as published; the live previews sit in the design system itself.

---

## COUNTER

The live keystroke tally: an odometer housing of fixed-width digit cells, at three sizes and in two states.

This is the brand's only moving part and the only component allowed to animate.

## WHAT THE CANVAS PROVIDES

XL settled, XL clearing with the delta stamp, M settled and clearing, S settled and clearing.

## CONSTRUCTION

- Housing: `base-900`, 1px `rule` border, cells divided by 1px `rule`, no gaps and no outer radius.
- Digits: `readout` in the `data` family at 500, `tabular-nums` forced. Separator cells are narrower and set in `rule`, which holds 3:1 on `base-900` in both themes.
- Seam: 1px `hairline`-weight rule across every cell at 62% — the drum axis.
- Cell sizes: XL 76 × 104 ( `space-19` wide), M 40 × 58, S 21 × 30. Separator cells 32 / 18 / 10.
- Label sits `space-3` beneath in `plate`, never inside the housing.

## STATES

**Settled.** The figure at rest. Everything `readout` and `ink`. No `signal` anywhere.

**Clearing.** The affected cells roll upward, 180ms, `linear`, and the delta appears alongside as `- 1,920` in `signal` with a 2px strike. It holds 400ms and is gone — it does not fade. The running total stays `readout`, because it is the number that remains.

## USAGE

- XL: one per page, on the homepage only.
- M: section and tile figures.
- S: inline in a table row, a crew card or a letterhead footer.
- Every counter states its scope and date in the label. A figure without a scope is not publishable — see **Counting method**.
- Under `prefers-reduced-motion`, render the settled figure and do not roll. The number is the point, not the roll.
- Never round up. Never abbreviate to 812K.

## DO NOT

Do not put a second moving element on a page with a counter. Do not colour the running total `signal` — red is only ever the delta or a struck baseline. Do not add a progress ring, a sparkline or a percentage.

---

## HOMEPAGE HERO

The homepage hero: nav bar, a `base-900` band carrying the tagline as the headline, and the XL counter on its own strip beneath.

## WHAT THE CANVAS PROVIDES

Full-width hero at 1280px: bar, hero band, counter strip and footer line.

## CONSTRUCTION

- Bar on `base-000`, `space-19` side margins, 1px `rule` beneath. Lockup left at 38px, nav right in `plate` with the active item carrying a 2px `live` underline.
- Hero band on `base-900`: eyebrow in `readout`, headline in `display-xl` upper case at a 13ch measure, `lede` beneath at a 52ch measure.
- Imagery: close-crop macro of a worn key, cropped so the cap fills the frame. Currently a drawn stand-in and labelled as one — see **Imagery and motion**.
- Counter strip: XL counter flush left at `space-19`, label beneath in `plate readout`, preceded by the 9px `live` mark while the crew is running. The second voice line sits right, ranged right, at a 34ch measure.
- Footer line: `plate` in `ink-muted`, 1px `rule` above.

## USAGE

- The tagline is the headline. Upper case, full stop kept.
- One counter, one headline, one paragraph. Nothing else goes in the hero.
- The hero band and the counter strip are one continuous `base-900` field — do not separate them with a rule or a colour change.
- No button in the hero. The nav is the navigation.

## DO NOT

Do not add a scroll cue, a background pattern, a gradient or a video. Do not put a dashboard screenshot in the frame — the imagery is the worn object, not the software.

---

## CASE STUDY TILE

A case-study tile as it appears in the horizontal work showcase: sector, the cleared figure, the struck baseline, one sentence, and a tally bar.

## WHAT THE CANVAS PROVIDES

Three tiles in a rail, with the third running off the edge to show the scroll.

## CONSTRUCTION

- Tile: 420px wide, `base-100` fill, 1px `rule` border, no radius, no shadow. Gap between tiles is `space-8`. No `live` keyline — a case study is finished work, not a running process.
- Eyebrow in `eyebrow`, client descriptor in `figure` — sector, headcount, town, separated by middots.
- Headline figure in `counter-m`, unit in `body-s ink-muted` beside it on the baseline.
- Before/after line in `figure`: the baseline struck in `signal` with a 2px rule, arrow in `ink-muted`, the remainder in `ink`.

- Copy in `body-s`, two sentences at most.
- Tally bar: 14px tall, `ink` for the cleared portion, `rule` for what a person still types, 2px gap. It is a tally, not a chart — no axis, no label, no percentage.
- Foot: 1px `hairline` above, scope left and go-live date right, both in `plate`.

## USAGE

- Every tile is identical down the rail — `base-100` inside a `rule` border. The rail does not alternate fills: under Instrument two adjacent dark grounds are indistinguishable, and a difference that only exists in the light theme is not a difference.
- `signal` appears once per tile, on the struck baseline only. The figure that remains is `ink`.
- Every figure comes from a ledger row. Rounded down, scoped, dated. See **Counting method**.
- Client descriptors are anonymised to sector, headcount and town unless the client has agreed in writing to be named.

## DO NOT

Do not add a logo, a testimonial, a star rating or a percentage. Do not put a photograph of the client's office in the tile. Do not colour the cleared figure red.

---

## CREW CARD

Roster card for one agent in the overnight crew: designation, function, schedule and running total, on a stamped plate with a punched-tape identifier.

Presented openly as an agent. Never as an employee, and never with a face.

## WHAT THE CANVAS PROVIDES

One card at working size, with the reasoning for each decision alongside.

## CONSTRUCTION

- Card: 1px `rule` border on `base-000`, no radius, no shadow.
- Plate: `base-900` strip, designation left in `plate` `readout`, crew position right in `ink-muted` preceded by the `live` mark — which renders only while the agent is actually running.
- Tape: eight channels of punched tape in `readout` on `base-900`, sprocket row through the fifth channel. It encodes the designation; it is a machine-readable label, not a texture.
- Fields: two-column definition list, labels in `plate` `ink-muted`, values in `body-s`. Schedule and running total are in the `data` family.
- Running total: a Counter / S housing, identical to every other figure in the system.
- Status bar: 1px `rule` above, **Not a person**. left in `plate` `ink`, qualifier right in `ink-muted`.

## FIELDS

`designation` · `function` · `schedule` · `runningTotal` · plus the fixed status line.

# USAGE

- Designation is a unit number and a verb: Unit 07 — Reconcile. Never a human first name, never a nickname, never a persona.
- Function is written as a limit — say what the agent will not do.
- Schedule is 24-hour with the zone and the run count. An agent that is "always on" is a claim, not a schedule.
- **Not a person.** is a field at field weight inside the card. It is not a footnote and it does not move to the bottom of the page.

# DO NOT

Do not add a photograph, an avatar, an illustrated character, a personality line, a "favourite task" or a status like "online". Do not use `signal` on this card — a crew card is not a live clearance. `live` renders only while the agent is actually running, never as decoration.

---

## LETTERHEAD

A4 letterhead. The footer carries the recipient's own running total, so every letter leaves branded with their number rather than our claim.

# WHAT THE CANVAS PROVIDES

A full A4 sheet at 595 × 842, with the print specification alongside.

# CONSTRUCTION

- Margins: 76px ( `space-19` , the keycap pitch) left and right, 56px top. Everything hangs off the left margin; nothing on the sheet is centred.
- Masthead: keycap lockup at 44px, contact block ranged right in `plate` `ink-muted` .
- Meta row: date, reference and baseline date in the `data` family over a 1px `rule` .
- Body: `body-s` at a 60ch measure. Every figure inside the prose is in the `data` family, tabular, including mid-sentence.
- Sign-off: name in `display-s` , role in `plate` `ink-muted` .
- Footer: full-bleed `base-900` band, 60px, tagline and URLs left in `plate` , a Counter / S housing right with the client's cleared total and a `readout` caption.

# PRINT SPECIFICATION

Uncoated 120gsm natural white. Two colours: ink black plus a cool grey for the band and the key face. Continuation sheets drop the masthead and carry the 32px mark at the left margin instead.

# USAGE

- The footer total is the recipient's figure, pulled from the ledger, rounded down, and it is stated for them by name.
- No `signal` and no `live` on stationery. A letter is neither a live clearance nor a running process; both treatments belong on screen.
- One rule and one inverted band on the sheet. No boxes, no second tint, no watermark.

# DO NOT

Do not repeat the logotype in the footer. Do not add a tagline lockup under the masthead — the tagline lives in the footer band on stationery. Do not print the counter housing in a spot colour; it is ink black with the cool grey band alongside it.

---

## LOGOTYPE 01 — TALLY

Direction 01: KEYSTROKE set in condensed caps over a tally rule, with the deleted stroke struck through in signal red.

A stroke is both a keystroke and a tally stroke, so the mark measures the thing the business sells with the same gesture it uses to name it.

# WHAT THE CANVAS PROVIDES

Type treatment, lockup with tagline, and the reduced mark at 32px, 32px reversed, and 96px.

# CONSTRUCTION

- Wordmark: `display` at 600, upper case, `-0.005em`, colour `ink`.
- Rule: 2px in `ink` at the full width of the word, with nine ticks — one under each letter — dropping 15% of the cap height.
- Struck stroke: a single diagonal in `signal` crossing the last five ticks, rising left to right at roughly 2°.
- Tagline in `lede`, `space-4` below the rule, flush left to the same edge.

# USAGE

- Minimum width 180px. Below that the ticks merge and the lockup fails — use the reduced mark.
- Clear space is the cap height of the K on all four sides.
- The struck stroke is the one sanctioned exception to "one signal per screen": inside the lockup it is part of the mark, not a state.
- On `base-900`, the wordmark and rule go to `ink-inverse`. The struck stroke stays `signal`.
- Never redraw the ticks at a different count. Nine letters, nine ticks.
- Never place the lockup over photography, on `readout`, or at an angle.

# DO NOT

Do not animate the struck stroke in the lockup — the strike is fixed. Do not use the tally mark as a bullet, a divider or a loading indicator.

---

## LOGOTYPE 02 — DRUM

Direction 02: KEYSTROKE set one letter per odometer cell, with the final E caught mid-roll.

The logo is a mechanism in the middle of counting, which states the whole proposition before a word of copy is read.

# WHAT THE CANVAS PROVIDES

Wordmark at full size, a reversed wordmark on `base-900`, and the reduced mark at 32px and 96px.

## CONSTRUCTION

- Housing: 2px `ink` border, nine cells, each cell divided by a 1px `hairline`.
- Cell ratio 58 × 84 — a reduced key pitch, held exactly. Letters at 66px in `display` 600, optically centred.
- Drum seam: 1px `hairline` across every cell at 66% height.
- Roll: the ninth cell holds two E's — one at +16%, one at -84% — clipped by the cell. The roll is a drawn state, not an animation, in the logotype.
- Descender rule: 6px `ink`, full width, `space-1` below the housing.

## USAGE

- Minimum width 240px. This is the widest and least flexible of the three directions; below 240px drop to the reduced mark.
- The Drum lockup carries no tagline. The mechanism has already said the sentence.
- Reversed on `base-900`: border, letters and descender rule go to `readout`; dividers and seam go to `hairline`.
- Budget for the mark being used more often than the wordmark — favicons, app icons and narrow headers cannot take nine cells.

## DO NOT

Do not roll a different letter into the ninth cell — the word never changes. Do not vary the cell width per letter; the whole point is that the cells are fixed and the letters are not.

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## LOGOTYPE 03 — KEYCAP

Direction 03: the initial K set as a worn legend on a keycap, with the remaining letters plain on the key's baseline.

The client already owns this object and has already worn it out, so the mark is a piece of their evidence rather than a piece of our decoration.

# WHAT THE CANVAS PROVIDES

Wordmark, lockup with tagline, and the reduced mark at 32px, 32px on `base-900`, and 96px.

## CONSTRUCTION

- Shell: `radius-cap` in `base-900` with a 1px `rule` edge, square, with `shadow-rest` beneath — one hard 2px offset in `rule`, no blur.
- Face: `radius-key` in `readout`, inset 5px left and right, 4px top, with a 6px `rule` band at the foot as the key's front edge.
- Legend: the K in `base-900`, cap height 54% of the shell, optically centred on the face.
- Wear: `readout`-coloured facets cut into the lower-right leg and the arm junction. Wear is texture, not geometry — it is not built from the radius scale and it is not symmetrical.

- Remaining letters: `display 600`, cap height matched to the K, `-0.005em`, gap 18px at full size.

## USAGE

- Works from 120px wide, the smallest of the three directions.
- The keycap mark is two-tone and holds on every ground in the palette, in both themes, from one file — `keycap-mark.svg`. There is no reversed variant and none is needed.
- Tagline sits `space-4` below, flush left to the keycap's left edge.
- Clear space is the cap height of the K on all four sides.

## DO NOT

Do not add more wear, and do not make it symmetrical or repeatable — a pattern of wear reads as a texture, and a texture reads as decoration. Do not set the remaining letters inside keys; one key, eight letters. Do not use the keycap as a button.

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KEYSTROKE / DESIGN SYSTEM / INSTRUMENT PALETTE ADOPTED.  
TOKENS, BRAND BOOK, EVERY CANVAS AND EVERY MARK REBUILT  
ON IT; PALETTE CANDIDATES REMOVED; BUILD NOTES ADDED.

Printed from the KEYSTROKE design system. Component previews, the Marks asset files and generated token CSS live in the system itself and are not reproduced here.